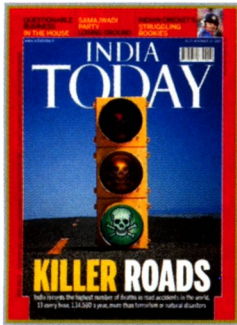


Killer Roads

NOVEMBER 23, 2009

India records the highest number of deaths in road accidents in the world, 13 every hour, 1,14,590 a year, more than terrorism or natural disasters



“The increasing number of road accidents in India has left a trail of trauma and stress. It is clear that road-related accidents cost India millions every year, yet there is no sign of any intervention.”

VINOD C. DIXIT, *Ahmedabad*

The Death Zone

No city or town of India can boast of having orderly traffic (“Killer Roads”, November 23). Both the Central and state governments have failed to provide proper infrastructure, create awareness and enforce traffic laws to meet the needs of the expanding traffic. No wonder then that India has 13 casualties every hour and 1,14,590 every year, more than terrorism or natural disasters. The sad thing is that even now a sense of urgency is not visible in political or bureaucratic quarters.

R.J. KHURANA,
Bhopal

The authorities are well aware how our roads are turning into killing fields year after year. The first to be blamed are vehicle



Fall From Glory

The tenuous truce brokered by party bigwigs just to save the first BJP Government in Karnataka exposes the diminishing credibility of a political party that had its government at the Centre not long ago. (“Yeddy Go Steady”, November 23). Chief Minister B.S. Yeddyurappa, whose style of functioning cannot be called exemplary, may find it hard to explain why he had to surrender to the whims and fancies of a few individuals whose USP is only money and muscle power.

P.P. SETHUMADHAVAN, *via www.indiatoday.in*

Peace may have prevailed finally in the Karnataka BJP unit but it has not done any good for the party which is in the doldrums. They must bring discipline into the party, a quality they were once famous for.

BAL GOVIND, *Noida*

users themselves who callously flout traffic rules and regulations with impunity. This is aided by the traffic police which is simply incapable of enforcing traffic discipline, and is also partly hamstrung because fines for violators do not act as a deterrent. The role of others like the RTIs, bad road design, etc also come in the loop. An indifferent government must share the major blame for till now there is no evidence that it is seriously concerned about the loss of lives, since there is no attempt to make systemic changes.

H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA,
Mysore

Sticking Point

Yet another bone of contention between India and China has been the Dalai Lama's visit to Tawang

FOR SUBSCRIPTION ASSISTANCE, CONTACT: Customer Care, India Today Group, A-61, Sector-57, Noida (Uttar Pradesh)-201301.

Phones: 2479900 from Noida, 95120-2479900 from Delhi and Faridabad, and 0120-2479900 from Rest of India.

Toll Free No.: 1800 1800 100. Fax: 0120-4078080. E-mail: wecare@intoday.com